

Kunal Malhotra

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SUMMARY

Seasoned Platform Engineer with expertise in cloud-native platforms, large-scale financial services infrastructure, and DevOps automation. Specializing in Kubernetes, OpenShift, Terraform, Istio, CI/CD (GitHub Actions, ArgoCD), cloud observability and MCP server configuration and management. Proven ability to design and optimize cloud architectures, automate infrastructure management, and implement SRE best practices to enhance reliability, scalability, and performance. Experience working with multinational enterprises, including FPT Software, McKinsey & Company, N26, and IBM to deliver resilient, high-performing cloud systems.

EXPERIENCE

FPT Software

Lead Platform Engineer | June'24 – Present

- Led SRE and DevOps transformation for a multinational bank in Saudi Arabia, conducting application assessment and implementing a DORA-aligned framework for deployment across hybrid infrastructures (OpenShift, IBM Power Server, IBM Mainframe).
- Designed a Kubernetes-based landing zone on Google Cloud for a public sector organization, incorporating multi-cluster Istio service mesh, IaC using terraform, observability using multi-cluster elasticsearch/kibana and grafana, thanos and prometheus architecture.
- Led the database migration for a public-sector organization onto google cloud. Responsibilities included data assessment, preparation and implementation of landing zone. Architecture and development of ETL pipeline and data replication with minimal downtime.
- Developed an FinOps platform from ground up using Opencost, prometheus and grafana that resulting in optimizing infrastructure spend by 20% across different client implementation.
- Developed a VM workload migration solution to OpenShift on AWS, standardizing enterprise migration frameworks and automating workload onboarding.
- Designing and implementing workflow/tool to increase the productivity of platform engineering using the agentic AI approach i.e., integrating core platform engineering system for example, Kubernetes, Terraform, Saltstack to apt LLM via a mcp server.
- Participate in hiring DevOps engineers for platform engineering team, focus on identifying candidates with strong skills in CI/CD pipelines, automation and cloud technologies.

McKinsey & Company

Senior Cloud Engineer I – Cloud by McKinsey Team | Jan'23 – Oct'23

- Cloud advisory and architecture consulting for enterprise clients, focusing on AWS-native architectures and DevOps best practices.
- Provided guidance to a financial institution on enhancing their MQ-based application through the implementation of an automated testing workflow using Azure DevOps. Leveraged extensive knowledge in cloud-native technologies and DevOps methodologies and recommended a tailored approach to optimize application testing and performance. By introducing Azure DevOps, they facilitated the creation of a streamlined and automated testing process, aiming to enhance application reliability and efficiency. This initiative empowered the financial institution to improve the quality of their MQ-based application while adhering to industry best practices in testing and development.
- Led FinOps and SRE initiatives for a multinational firm, optimizing AWS IaaS/PaaS and Redhat OpenShift, achieving a 20% cost reduction in cloud spend.

N26

Site Reliability Engineer – Connectivity Team | Dec '21-Dec '22

- Led the architecture design and engineering, including the development of automation for provisioning of Infrastructure (Multi-VPC architecture, site-to-site vpn) and integration of a partner

bank to enable N26 to process instant payments in one of the Euro countries. The custom-designed and engineered solution supports over 1 million payments per day.

- Participated in the implementation of a service mesh based on Istio, laying the foundation for a zero-trust network.
- Led a proof of concept (PoC) to implement a service mesh into N26's infrastructure deployed on AWS to reduce the time and effort of integration (end-to-end encryption for data in motion with mTLS, routing, service discovery) with applications running in virtual machines.
- Led the development of automation required by the connectivity team during system maintenance of AWS infrastructure. Automation eliminated potential human error and reduced the time required for system maintenance by 95%.
- Participated in the implementation and maintenance of the company-wide networking platform services, including AWS site-to-site VPNs with external partners and client-to-site VPNs for internal employees, creation and securing of all networking components (AWS VPC, AWS load balancers, AWS PrivateLinks, DNS Server/Service management, Certificate and Secret Management).
- Participated in regular developer support on call.
- Participated in incidents and conducted root cause analysis meetings.

IBM

Cloud Platform Engineer - Cloud Platform Team | Oct '18-Nov '21

- Led the migration of a multinational bank's mobile banking environment from on-prem to cloud. Responsibilities included analyzing services that could be migrated to the cloud with no or minimal changes, building and executing the plan to make necessary changes in services not ready for the cloud, developing and implementing the landing zone, integrating with the bank's on-prem network, safely migrating data from on-prem databases to the cloud, developing CI/CD pipelines, and implementing the IBM Cloud for Financial Services Framework to meet risk and compliance needs.
- Led the implementation of Red Hat OpenShift Platform at the edge for a multinational bank, enabling the bank to deliver services to clients while meeting the data residency compliance requirements.
- Participated in delivering successful pilots and projects for several clients across industries, including regulated industries.
- Co-authored the "Client Reference Architecture Playbook" an IBM Academy of Technology initiative, used globally by clients to set their cloud-native architecture strategy.
- Worked with the global tech sales team to create a scalable platform strategy using KubeVirt to help modernize customer workloads. The approach focused on hybrid cloud environments while supporting ongoing modernization efforts.
- Created and delivered enablement content on cloud-native technologies, including Docker, OpenShift, Kubernetes, Istio, Tekton, Terraform, KubeVirt and IBM Cloud Services to enterprise clients and IBM teams.
- Evangelized IBM Cloud by working directly with IBM's early adopter program, including client success with Kubernetes, OpenShift, and virtual private cloud.

Cloud Advocate and Developer - Cloud Platform Team | Sept '17-Sept '18

- Delivered an MVP (first stage) for a government project as a front-end developer that produced a sound foundation for the project.
- Designed and developed a proof of concept (PoC) based on automating insurance claims via blockchain for a government client. The client selected the PoC, which was showcased at the Arab Health Conference 2018.
- Developed a skills-based search engine using cloud-native technologies that connected tech sellers with the optimal skill set for client engagements.
- Increased IBM Cloud Services (IBM Kubernetes services, cloud databases, Watson services, and DevOps) skills for architects and technical sellers by developing a platform to share knowledge and hands-on experience. The focus was on sharing best practices, demos, and technical collateral across IBM Cloud teams.
- Trained 100+ developers using IBM Cloud Technologies by producing training materials and conducting workshops with hands-on labs.

EDUCATION

Birla Institute of Technology and Science, Pilani - Dubai Campus

Bachelor Of Engineering (Honors) in Computer Science | Class of 2018

Bachelor Thesis

Large Scale Sentiment Analysis Using Apache Spark

Prof. V Santosh Kumar | Feb '18-May '18

- Built a framework for large-scale sentiment analysis capable of handling hundreds of nodes using Apache Spark, Apache Kafka, MLlib2, Pandas, Matplotlib, and Python.
- Implemented the famous bag-of-words algorithm from scratch.

SKILLS

Red Hat OpenShift, Kubernetes, kAgent, Knative, Docker, Service Mesh (Istio), Helm, Jenkins, ArgoCD, Terraform, Vault, Consul, Python (Flask), GoLang, Git, ELK Stack, Datadog, AWS Cloud Platform, IBM Cloud Platform, Google Cloud Platform Site-to-Site VPNs, Client-to-Site VPNs, SaltStack, GitHub Actions.

CERTIFICATIONS

Name	Issuing Organization
Certified Kubernetes Application Developer	The Linux Foundation
IBM Certified Application Developer - Cloud Platform V2	IBM
Red Hat Certified Specialist in OpenShift Administration	Red Hat
IBM Architectural Thinking	IBM
AWS Certified Solutions Architect - Associate	Amazon
AWS Certified DevOps Engineer - Professional	Amazon
AWS Certified Advanced Networking - Specialty	Amazon

AWARDS

- Awarded "Rookie of the Year" for technical achievements at IBM's Annual Recognition event in Spain.
- Won Runner-Up Prize at Junction 2018 (Europe's Biggest Hackathon) in Finland.
- Won 2nd Prize (Best use of data) at Dubai Happiness Tech Sprint 2018, organized by Startupbootcamp and SAP.
- Presented Paccked (Startup) at IATA International Business Travel Summit 2017 in Geneva, Switzerland.
- Won the Developer Prize Award and Emirates Special Award for Best API usage at IATA NDC Hackathon held in Dubai.
- Won the Bronze Medal at the Ministry of Finance Smart City Hackathon held in Dubai.
- Received 1st place in CodeJam 2016 organized by Oracle at Middlesex University Dubai.
- Received 3rd place in the Visa Digital Payment Hackathon 2016 held in Dubai.
- Won 3rd Prize and incubation at Hamdan Innovation Incubator at Hacka{MENA} Hackathon held in Dubai.
- Received 2nd place in IoTX Hackathon 2015, organized by the Government of Dubai.